

## 018. Chapter 2 Verses 48-51

Lectures by Swami Sarvapriyananda

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### VERSE 2.48

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योगस्थः कुरु कर्माणि सङ्गं त्यक्त्वा धनञ्जय ।  
सिद्धयसिद्धयोः समो भूत्वा समत्वं योग उच्यते ॥ 48 ॥

*yoga-sthaḥ kuru karmāṇi saṅgaṁ tyaktvā dhanañjaya*  
*siddhy-asiddhyoḥ samo bhūtvā samatvaṁ yoga uchyate*

**yoga-sthaḥ**—being steadfast in yog; **kuru**—perform; **karmāṇi**—duties; **saṅgaṁ**—attachment; **tyaktvā**—having abandoned; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **siddhi-asiddhyoḥ**—in success and failure; **samaḥ**—equipoised; **bhūtvā**—becoming; **samatvam**—equanimity; **yogaḥ**—Yog; **uchyate**—is called

**O Arjuna! Steadfast in Yoga, giving up all attachment, unmindful of success or failure, do your work. Such equanimity of mind is called Yoga.**

### VERSE 2.49

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दूरेण ह्यवरं कर्म बुद्धियोगाद्धनञ्जय ।  
बुद्धौ शरणमन्विच्छ कृपणाः फलहेतवः ॥ 49 ॥

*dūreṇa hy-avarāṁ karma buddhi-yogād dhanañjaya*  
*buddhau śharaṇam anvichchha kṛpaṇāḥ phala-hetavaḥ*

**dūreṇa**—(dis)crad from far away; **hi**—certainly; **avarām**—inferior; **karma**—reward-seeking actions; **buddhi-yogāt**—with the intellect established in Divine knowledge; **dhanañjaya**—Arjun; **buddhau**—divine knowledge and insight; **śharaṇam**—refuge; **anvichchha**—seek; **kṛpaṇāḥ**—miserly; **phala-hetavaḥ**—those seeking fruits of their work

**O Arjuna! Work with attachment is far inferior to nishkama karma. Therefore seek refuge in desireless action with equanimity of mind. Those who work for fruits and rewards are wrecked.**

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बुद्धियुक्तो जहातीह उभे सुकृतदुष्कृते ।  
तस्माद्योगाय युज्यस्व योगः कर्मसु कौशलम् ॥ 50 ॥

*buddhi-yukto jahātiha ubhe sukrīta-duṣhkṛite*  
*tasmād yogāya yujyasva yogaḥ karmasu kauśhalam*

**buddhi-yuktaḥ**—endowed with wisdom; **jahāti**—get rid of; **iha**—in this life; **ubhe**—both; **sukrīta-duṣhkṛite**—good and bad deeds; **tasmāt**—therefore; **yogāya**—for Yog; **yujyasva**—strive for; **yogaḥ**—yog is; **karmasu kauśhalam**—the art of working skillfully

The man of equanimity born of wisdom releases himself both from good and bad even in this life. Therefore strive for nishkama karma with an equal mind. Yoga is skill in action.

कर्मजं बुद्धियुक्ता हि फलं त्यक्त्वा मनीषिणः ।  
जन्मबन्धविनिर्मुक्ताः पदं गच्छन्त्यनामयम् ॥ 51 ॥

*karma-jam buddhi-yuktā hi phalaṁ tyaktvā manīṣiṇaḥ*  
*janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ padam gachchhanty-anāmayam*

**karma-jam**—born of fruitive actions; **buddhi-yuktāḥ**—endowed with equanimity of intellect; **hi**—as; **phalam**—fruits; **tyaktvā**—abandoning; **manīṣiṇaḥ**—the wise; **janma-bandha-vinirmuktāḥ**—freedom from the bondage of life and death; **padam**—state; **gachchhanti**—attain; **anāmayam**—devoid of sufferings

Wise men endowed with equanimity, having abandoned the fruits of action, go to the abode beyond all sorrow and evil.